

RATIONALISM

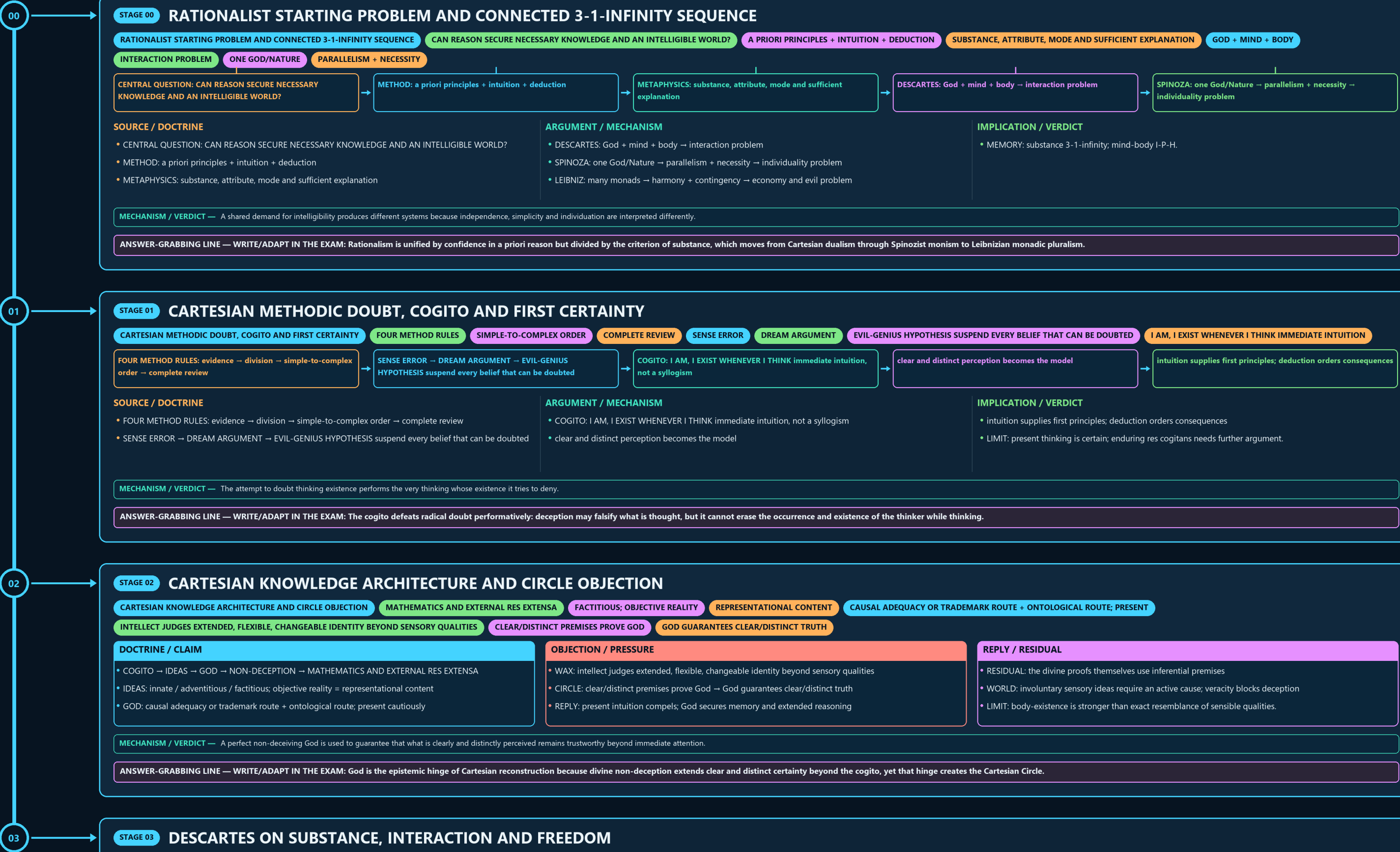
RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND → CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO → CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND → DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION → SPINOZA'S SUBSTANCE-ATTRIBUTE-MODE HIERARCHY AND → SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



- **WORLD:** involuntary sensory ideas require an active cause; veracity blocks deception
- **LIMIT:** body-existence is stronger than exact resemblance of sensible qualities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is the epistemic hinge of Cartesian reconstruction because divine non-deception extends clear and distinct certainty beyond the cogito, yet that hinge creates the Cartesian Circle.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cartesian dualism gains conceptual clarity by separating thought from extension, but its success in distinction becomes its central causal problem because heterogeneous substances must still explain one life.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza radicalises the Cartesian definition of substance until only God or Nature remains self-conceived, making minds and bodies dependent modes rather than independently interacting things.

SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE FROM BONDAGE TO FREEDOM

ONE EVENT

UNDER THOUGHT

UNDER EXTENSION

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS

NO CROSS-ATTRIBUTE CAUSAL TRANSFER; PARALLELISM REPLACES CARTESIAN INTERACTION

FINITE MODES ARE NECESSARILY CAUSED; CONTINGENCY RECORDS IGNORANCE OF

ONE EVENT → under THOUGHT: idea → under EXTENSION: body-state

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS

NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction

FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ONE EVENT → under THOUGHT: idea → under EXTENSION: body-state

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS

NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes

CONATUS = each thing's striving to persevere in being

INADEQUATE IDEAS + external causes → passive affects → BONDAGE

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

COMMON NOTIONS / REASON / INTUITION → ADEQUATE IDEAS → ACTIVITY

FREEDOM = acting from understood nature within necessity, not uncaused choice

LIMIT: autonomy survives, but alternative possibilities do not.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

The same modal event is expressed under Thought as an idea and under Extension as a body-state, eliminating cross-attribute causal transfer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

Spinoza reconciles freedom with determinism by treating freedom not as uncaused choice but as adequate self-determination within the necessary order of God or Nature.

06

STAGE 06

LEIBNIZ'S MONAD HIERARCHY, PERCEPTION AND INDIVIDUALITY

LEIBNIZ'S MONAD HIERARCHY, PERCEPTION AND INDIVIDUALITY

WHY MONADS? EXTENSION IS DIVISIBLE; ULTIMATE SUBSTANCE MUST BE

NECESSARY SUPREME MONAD

COMPLETE INTELLIGENCE

RATIONAL SPIRITS

APPERCEPTION + REASON + MORAL AGENCY

ANIMAL SOULS

MEMORY + CLEARER PERCEPTION

WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple

GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence

RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency

ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple

GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence

RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception

BARE MONADS: obscure petites perceptions

EVERY MONAD: simple, unextended, windowless, perceptive and appetitive

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

APPETITION = internal transition; each perspective expresses the universe

IDENTITY OF INDISCERNIBLES secures uniqueness

BODIES = well-founded phenomena, not ultimate substances.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

Appetition moves each monad from one perception to another according to its own law, while its perspective differentiates it from every other monad.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

Leibniz makes substance simple and active: each monad is a unique perspectival centre whose internally unfolding perceptions preserve individuality without material parts or causal influx.

07

STAGE 07

LEIBNIZIAN HARMONY, SUFFICIENT REASON, CONTINGENCY AND FREEDOM

LEIBNIZIAN HARMONY, SUFFICIENT REASON, CONTINGENCY AND FREEDOM

GOD CHOOSES A COMPOSSIBLE BEST WORLD UNDER THE PRINCIPLE

MIND-MONAD STATES UNFOLD INTERNALLY

BODILY/ORGANIC STATES UNFOLD INTERNALLY

PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY MAKES THEM CORRESPOND WITHOUT INTERACTION

TRUTHS OF REASON

OPPOSITE CONTRADICTORY

LOGICALLY NECESSARY

GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON

mind-monad states unfold internally

bodily/organic states unfold internally

PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON

mind-monad states unfold internally

bodily/organic states unfold internally

PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

TRUTHS OF REASON: opposite contradictory → logically necessary

TRUTHS OF FACT: opposite conceivable → contingent though certain

COMPLETE CONCEPT: all predicates belong to the individual known fully by God

FREEDOM: spontaneity + intelligence + contingency; reasons incline, not coerce

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

OBJECTION: programming/evil; REPLY: self-expression + optimal compossibility

LIMIT: compatibility is stronger than libertarian freedom.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

God chooses a compossible world and creates monads whose internally lawful sequences correspond without causal exchange.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

Leibniz preserves freedom by distinguishing certainty from absolute necessity: rational actions arise spontaneously from the agent's own reasons, which incline without necessitating in the logical sense.

08

STAGE 08

THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES

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LEIBNIZ SUBSTANCE

GOD + MIND + BODY

ONE GOD OR NATURE

MANY SIMPLE MONADS

IMMANENT REALITY

SELECTOR/COORDINATOR MIND-BODY

HARMONY ORDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — God chooses a compossible world and creates monads whose internally lawful sequences correspond without causal exchange.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Leibniz preserves freedom by distinguishing certainty from absolute necessity: rational actions arise spontaneously from the agent's own reasons, which incline without necessitating in the logical sense.

08

STAGE 08

THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES

THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXESLEIBNIZ SUBSTANCEGOD + MIND + BODYONE GOD OR NATUREMANY SIMPLE MONADSIMMANENT REALITYSELECTOR/COORDINATOR MIND-BODYHARMONY ORDER

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
LEIBNIZ substance	selector/coordinator mind-body	rational assent
God + mind + body	harmony order	adequate activity
one God or Nature	mechanism + will	intelligent spontaneity
many simple monads	strict necessity	PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap → monist unity → restored individuality.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- LEIBNIZ substance
- God + mind + body
- one God or Nature
- many simple monads
- immanent reality

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- selector/coordinator mind-body
- harmony order
- mechanism + will
- strict necessity
- certain/contingent freedom

EVALUATION / TRAP

- rational assent
- adequate activity
- intelligent spontaneity
- PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap → monist unity → restored individuality.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each successor accepts the Cartesian pressure but redistributes substance and causation to avoid direct interaction between heterogeneous realities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza removes the interaction gap by collapsing Cartesian substances into attributes of one order, while Leibniz restores plurality by replacing interaction with divinely coordinated internal activity.

09

STAGE 09

CRITICISM-REPLY LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE

CRITICISM-REPLY LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINEINTERACTION GAPPRIMITIVE UNIONMECHANISM REMAINS OPAQUEADEQUATE ACTIVITY + MODAL REALITYNO ALTERNATIVESSPONTANEITY + POSSIBLE WORLDSRESIDUAL PRESSURE

DESCARTES: interaction gap → primitive union → mechanism remains opaque

→

SPINOZA: necessity/acosmism → adequate activity + modal reality → no alternatives

→

LEIBNIZ: programming/evil/economy → spontaneity + possible worlds → residual pressure

→

PRECISION: substance != attribute != mode; mind != person; necessity != fatalism

→

PRECISION: spontaneity != autonomy; compatibilism != libertarian freedom

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- DESCARTES: interaction gap → primitive union → mechanism remains opaque
- SPINOZA: necessity/acosmism → adequate activity + modal reality → no alternatives
- LEIBNIZ: programming/evil/economy → spontaneity + possible worlds → residual pressure
- PRECISION: substance != attribute != mode; mind != person; necessity != fatalism

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- PRECISION: spontaneity != autonomy; compatibilism != libertarian freedom
- PYQ ROUTES: certainty/self-world; substance 3-1-infinity; pantheism; freedom
- PYQ ROUTES: innate ideas; monads/harmony; God; determination/negation
- ANSWER SPINE

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- directive → thesis → definitions → argument → example → objection → reply → verdict
- CONTROL: claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification
- VERDICT: intelligibility is gained at recurring costs to interaction and autonomy.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Precision turns system summaries into answers by linking every doctrine to a named inferential role and an explicit qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A criticism-reply answer spine reveals rationalism's central tension: systematic intelligibility repeatedly pressures interaction, contingency and autonomous individuality.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTADVANCED SESSION 1 — RATIONALISM MASTER MAP AND BASICADVANCED SESSION 2 — CARTESIAN DOUBT, COGITO AND CERTAINADVANCED SESSION 3 — WAX, EXTERNAL WORLD, DIVINE GUARANTEEADVANCED SESSION 4 — SUBSTANCEONE INHERITED CRITERION, DESCARTES 3, SPINOZA 1, LEIBNIZ INFINITYADVANCED SESSION 5 — GODCARTESIAN GUARANTEE, SPINOZIST IMMANENT NATURE, LEIBNZIAN SELECTOR

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Rationalism Master Map and Basic Tenets
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Cartesian Doubt, Cogito and Certain Self-Knowledge
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Wax, External World, Divine Guarantee and the Cartesian Circle
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Substance: One Inherited Criterion, Descartes 3, Spinoza 1, Leibniz Infinity

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — God: Cartesian Guarantee, Spinozist Immanent Nature, Leibnizian Selector
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Mind and Body: Interactionism, Parallelism and Pre-Established Harmony
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Freedom and Determinism Across the Rationalist Trio
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Spinoza's Integrated System: Necessity, Knowledge, Pantheism and Negation

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Leibniz: Monads, Sufficient Reason, Contingency and Harmony
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Criticisms, Comparisons, PYQ Routing and Provenance-Safe Answer Architecture
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- Core prerequisite : finish the owner first for Cartesian Method and Certain Knowledge

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.